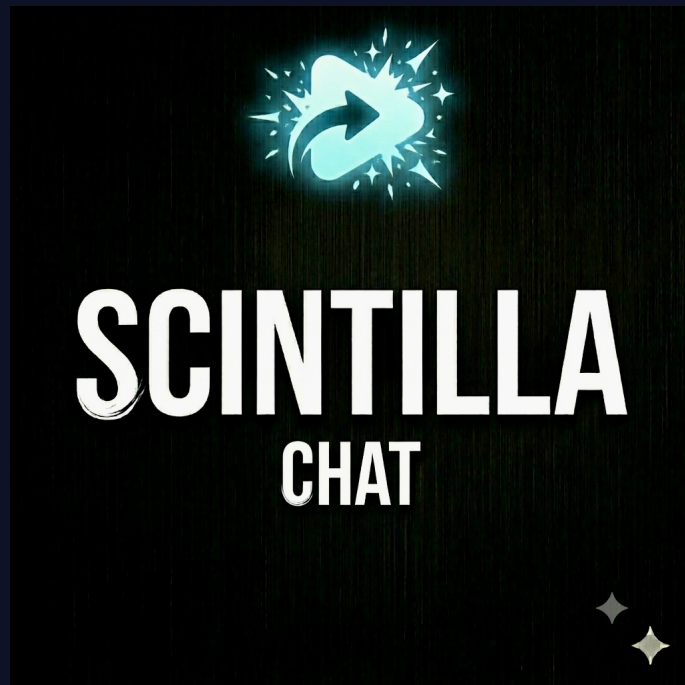




SCINTILLA CHAT · CONFIDENTIAL · MARKET CONTEXT

Why we sell the tool, not the service

The cartomancy market is a jungle of price wars and ad spend.
We make money from the picks and shovels, not the gold rush.

Internal alignment document — real market data on Wengo, Kang and the wider sector.

1. The thesis, in one line

We are not cartomancers, and we do not sell readings to the public. We build and sell the tool — the paid chat — to the people who already provide readings: card readers, psychics, esoteric studios, small agencies in the sector.

Our customer is the operator, not the person seeking a reading. In a gold rush, we sell picks and shovels. We make money from the technology, not from the risk, the advertising or the legal exposure of how readers behave.

2. The market is real — and big

This is not a fringe niche. The numbers below are from public industry research.

Indicator	Figure	Source
Global online psychic-reading services market (2024)	≈ USD 2.2 billion, projected ≈ USD 4.5 bn by 2033 (8.8% CAGR)	Verified Market Reports
Europe's share of that market	≈ 28%	Verified Market Reports
French esoteric/voyance market	≈ EUR 4 billion/year, ~100,000 mediums	Lesmakers (affiliate-industry analysis)
Astrology app segment (2024)	≈ USD 3–4 billion, fast growth	MarkNtel / Global Growth Insights
Tarot/card readings as a share of online psychic market	≈ 40% (largest single type)	Verified Market Reports

Takeaway for us: demand is structural and growing. The problem is never the size of the market — it's how brutally competitive the consumer-facing end of it is.

2.1 — Italy, in numbers (our actual home market)

Indicator	Figure	Source / note
Operators in Italy (mages, card readers, astrologers)	≈ 155,000	Codacons estimate (widely cited, 2017); order-of-magnitude, includes all esoteric operators, not only card readers
Italians who use occult/esoteric services	≈ 13 million	Codacons estimate (2017)
Self-employed status	Freelance / Partita IVA (ATECO 96.09.09 or 96.99.99)	FlexTax, PartitaIVA.it — no dedicated register, so an exact count of 'cartomancers only' does not exist
Listed operators on a single ad portal (Bakeca)	astrologers ~1,000 · tarot ~490 · sensitives ~425 · 'professional card readers' ~261	Bakeca.it category counts (live), one platform only

Honest caveat: the 155,000 figure is a press/consumer-association estimate covering the whole esoteric sector, not an official census of card readers. There is no ATECO code exclusive to cartomancy, so a precise count is impossible. We use it as an order of magnitude: the pool of potential operator-customers in Italy is in the **tens of thousands**, not hundreds.

2.2 — What operators actually charge per minute (Italy)

Surveyed across live Italian advertising sites and platforms (2025–2026):

Channel / platform	Advertised per-minute rate
Low-cost credit-card / PayPal services (Mia, Cartomantiseri, Anekira, cartomanzia.eu)	€0.30 – €0.50/min
'Gold' / premium readers on the same low-cost sites	€0.50 – €0.60/min
899 premium-rate phone line	≈ €0.80/min (ex VAT) + connection fee; ~€0.93/min incl. VAT
Kang.it (platform promo)	€0.99/min
General 'typical' rate cited in consumer guides	≈ €1.50/min
Wengo (premium experts)	€1.50 – €3.50/min

The Italian street price clusters hard at **€0.30–€1.00/min**, with only branded premium platforms reaching €1.50–€3.50. The low end is a genuine price floor — several studios openly advertise €0.30/min as their cheapest tier. This is the race to the bottom, in our own market, in numbers.

Why this matters for our pricing: operators living on €0.30–€1.00/min margins are extremely cost-sensitive. A white-label fee of €250–350/month only works for studios running several readers with real volume — not for a solo reader at €0.30/min. This directly shapes who we can realistically sell to, and at what price.

3. The jungle: who fights, and how

The consumer-facing platforms compete head-to-head on the same two levers: **free first consultations** and **aggressive per-minute pricing**. Real examples from live competitor sites:

Platform	Positioning	Free hook	Per-minute price (public)
Wengo	Self-described European leader; 15+ yrs; thousands of experts; 7M+ consultations claimed	10 min offered / €1 intro	≈ €1.50 – €3.50/min
Kang.it	200+ vetted readers; 24/7	First consult free + bonus	€0.99/min promo
Telephone 899 (IT)	Legacy premium-rate phone channel	—	≈ €0.94 – €0.98/min + connection fee; €12.50 hard cap per call

Two structural facts make this a race to the bottom:

- **Free minutes are the default.** Every serious platform gives away the first consult. Acquisition is pure subsidy — paid out of marketing budget before a cent comes back.
- **Price is the battleground.** Kang advertises €0.99/min; the legacy 899 channel sits below €1/min with a forced €12.50 cap. Margins on the consumer side are thin and constantly compressed.

How much do they spend to win a client?

Exact advertising budgets for Wengo and Kang are **not publicly disclosed**, so we won't quote a fake number. But the spending is visible everywhere and confirmed by what the sources do show:

- Wengo runs a paid **affiliate program** paying up to ~€20 per converted client — a direct, documented customer-acquisition cost.
- Wengo's own readers describe **heavy advertising by the platform** to bring them clients (Glassdoor staff reviews).
- An entire Italian ad-agency ecosystem exists purely to sell cartomancy advertising — print (Di Più, Nuovo, Intimità), Google Ads, 899 promotion. Demand for ad space is the business.
- Free-first-minutes + affiliate payouts + print + Google Ads = a continuous, heavy cash outflow just to keep the funnel full.

Third-party advertising-intelligence tools (web/ad trackers such as SimilarWeb-class estimators) put **Kang's advertising spend at roughly €10,000+ per month**. Important: this is a tool-based *estimate*, not an official figure — such tools extrapolate from traffic and ad signals and carry a wide margin of error. We cite it as an indicative estimate, not as fact.

Honest framing: exact ad budgets are not published. Tool estimates (≈ €10k/month for Kang) and documented affiliate payouts (up to ~€20/client at Wengo) both point the same way: customer acquisition is the sector's single largest and most relentless cost — and it never stops. That entire cost line is one we simply do not have.

4. The other jungle: fraud and contact theft

Beyond price, the sector has a chronic integrity problem that hurts both clients and platforms:

- **Readers poaching contacts.** Operators routinely try to pull clients off-platform — swapping phone numbers or socials — to bill them privately and cut the platform out. Every per-minute platform fights this constantly.
- **Client-side distrust.** Public reviews repeatedly accuse platforms of being 'built to make money off people's problems'; billing and refund disputes are a recurring complaint even on highly-rated sites.
- **Compliance overhead.** Privacy/data concerns and GDPR push real operating costs onto anyone running a consumer platform; smaller players struggle with support and fraud-claim costs.

This is exactly where our product earns its keep: our chat automatically filters phone numbers, emails, social handles and links out of every message. For anyone running multiple readers, that single feature is a direct answer to their worst problem — and a strong reason to buy from us.

5. So what do we actually do

We step out of the price war entirely. We don't fight Wengo and Kang for clients — we sell tooling to the thousands of smaller operators who can never afford to fight Wengo and Kang, but still want to work online under their own brand.

	The platforms (Wengo, Kang...)	Us (Scintilla Chat)
Who they fight	Each other, for the public	Nobody — we equip the operators
Biggest cost	Advertising / client acquisition	Build once, then support
Pricing pressure	Brutal, race to the bottom	We price a tool, not a per-minute war
Legal exposure on readings	Theirs	None — we supply software
Contact-theft problem	Their daily headache	Our built-in selling point

We don't need to win the gold rush. We get paid every time someone buys a shovel — regardless of whether they strike gold.

6. What we could earn (our side only)

Important honesty note for the partner: the prices below are **our working hypotheses, not observed market rates**. There is no public benchmark for 'a cartomancy chat sold white-label'. To sanity-check them, here is what comparable white-label SaaS actually costs today:

Comparable product	Real public pricing	Source
White-label chatbot (SiteGPT, Chatbase)	≈ \$39 – \$199 / month	SiteGPT pricing guide, 2026
Agency reseller packages	≈ \$299 basic / \$699 premium / month	Socialintents, 2026
Enterprise chat platforms	\$2,500+ / month	SiteGPT pricing guide, 2026
Self-hosted open-source setup + hosting	tens of \$ / month (commodity)	Reseller listings

Read against this, our hypothesised **€250–350/month is at the upper end** of the commodity range. It is only defensible if we sell a **vertical solution** — built-in anti-fraud, Telecash already integrated, Italian-language support, sector know-how — and not 'just another chat'. If we position it as a generic tool, we will lose on price. The numbers below are scenarios to pressure-test, not promises.

6.1 — Hypothesis A: White-label, monthly fee

Active clients	Monthly fees (at €300)	Annual fee revenue	+ one-off setup*
5	€1,500	€18,000	€6,000 – €9,000
10	€3,000	€36,000	€12,000 – €18,000
25	€7,500	€90,000	€30,000 – €45,000

* Setup (€1,200–€1,800) is billed once per newly acquired client.

6.2 — Hypothesis B: Revenue share

Client's monthly turnover	Our share (20%)	Our annual revenue / client
€3,000	€600	€7,200
€8,000	€1,600	€19,200
€20,000	€4,000	€48,000

6.3 — Combined 12-month scenario (illustrative, best-case)

Source	Detail	Annual revenue (est.)
6 white-label clients	Avg €300/mo fee + setup	≈ €30,000
4 revenue-share clients	Avg €6,000/mo turnover, 20% share	≈ €57,600
1 licence sale	One-off, negotiated	≈ €6,000 – €12,000
INDICATIVE TOTAL		≈ €93,000 – €99,000

Illustrative only, gross of our costs and — critically — gross of OUR OWN customer acquisition. We avoid the readers' ad war, but we still have to find the operators who buy from us: that sales effort is our real cost, and it is not in these figures. Treat this page as a model to validate with 2–3 real pilot clients, not a forecast.

7. The leverage — and what we never do

The key point for the partner: **we build the tool once**. Each new client adds revenue without us redoing the work. Our marginal cost per extra client is low (hosting, support); their costs — advertising, readers, liability — stay with them.

For total clarity, things we do NOT do:

- ✗ We don't give readings.
- ✗ We don't acquire or manage the end clients.
- ✗ We don't burn money advertising to the public (the competitors' #1 cost).
- ✗ We don't recruit or pay cartomancers.
- ✗ We don't carry legal responsibility for how operators conduct readings.

We do one thing, well: we build and sell the tool that lets the sector work.

Internal alignment document. Names, commercial formulas and figures are indicative and subject to agreement between the partners. Market figures are sourced from public industry research (2024–2026); competitor ad budgets are not publicly disclosed and are not quoted as fact.

Sources

- Verified Market Reports — Online Psychic Reading Service Market (2024): ≈ \$2.2bn, Europe ≈ 28%, tarot ≈ 40% of type mix.
- Lesmakers (affiliate-industry comparison) — French voyance market ≈ €4bn, ~100,000 mediums; Wengo scale and affiliate commission (up to ~€20/client).
- MarkNtel Advisors / Global Growth Insights — Astrology app market ≈ \$3–4bn in 2024, high CAGR.
- Wengo public pages & Awin/Affi affiliate listings — leader positioning, free-minutes hook, €1.50–€3.50/min, affiliate payouts.
- Glassdoor (Wengo reader reviews) — platform's heavy advertising on readers' behalf.
- Kang.it public pages & FAQ — 200+ readers, free first consult, €0.99/min promo.
- Il Messaggero Italiano / 899-industry pages — Italian 899 pricing ≈ €0.94–0.98/min + connection, €12.50 per-call cap; print-advertising ecosystem (Di Più, Nuovo, Intimità).
- Market Growth Reports — GDPR/compliance and fraud-claim costs as operating burdens on psychic/astrology platforms.
- SiteGPT / Socialintents (2026) — white-label & reseller chatbot pricing benchmarks (\$39–\$699+/month).
- Third-party web/advertising-intelligence tools — Kang ad-spend estimate (~€10k/month); tool-based estimate, not official.
- Codacons (cited by PartitaIVA.it, 2017/2025) — ~155,000 esoteric operators and ~13 million users in Italy; consumer-association estimate, not official census.
- FlexTax / Regime-Forfettario.it — Italian ATECO codes for cartomancy (96.09.09 / 96.99.99); no dedicated register exists.
- Mia Cartomanzia, Cartomantiseri, Anekira, cartomanzia.eu, Bakeca (2025–2026) — live Italian per-minute pricing €0.30–€1.50/min; Bakeca category counts.